discussions with my team, I gave the concept, logic and rationale on which they would base their study. Then we sent questionnaires to different types of units serving in various theatres and diverse terrain and climate zones and asked them to provide details of the utilization of their existing fleets as authorized to them.

I was told that the ministry desired to see a corresponding reduction in the authorization based on the increased carrying capacity of the new generation of vehicles. My response was that if it was purely a mathematical formula, then there was no requirement of this study. A team of clerks with computers could do it! We had to study the operational and functional requirements of vehicles for each type of unit before the authorization could be recommended. If we had not adopted this unconventional procedure and merely followed the chain-of-command route, a study of this magnitude could well have taken a year or more. As soon as we got the response from the units, the sub-teams started finalizing the new scales based on the logic mentioned earlier. We finished our study on time.

The recommendations of the study group were accepted by the ministry of defence without any changes, and the revised authorizations notified to all concerned. Accordingly, new war and peace equipment tables were issued to all units of the Indian Army. We did achieve an overall reduction in the numbers of vehicles in the inventory of the army and a commensurate saving to the state. We also quantified the financial saving by the introduction of these new fuel-efficient vehicles. The ministry of defence and the Army HQ were very appreciative of our study.

When these vehicles were entering service, I decided that the highest priority should be given to J&K. As the first consignment was being sent to a transport company in J&K, I asked to see a Stallion vehicle from that lot. It was brought to Sena Bhawan in the Army HQ and though I was the DDGOL, a brigadier, I did not hesitate to drive it around to get a feel. After all, this was going to be the workhorse of the Indian Army for the next four decades. I noticed that instead of a bucket seat for the driver, the vehicle had an ordinary bench type of seat. How had the quality assurance guys